



Promoting Independence Workers – Adult Deaf & Visual Impairment Service (ADVIS)

Who do ADVIS Promoting Independence Workers work with?

ADVIS Promoting Independence Workers work with Deaf people who communicate in British Sign language (BSL) or Sign Supported English (SSE). They also work with Deafblind people who have specialist communication needs. The service works with adults who live in Nottinghamshire County. ADVIS Promoting Independence Workers communicate in sign language and understand the needs of Deaf people and Deafblind people.

What are the objectives of the Promoting Independence Service provided by ADVIS?

ADVIS Promoting Independence Workers support Deaf BSL users and Deafblind people to learn new skills that they have not had the opportunity to learn before, working towards and achieving goals that are important to them.

What support do ADVIS Promoting Independence Workers offer?

ADVIS Promoting Independence workers work with people face-to-face, either in their own home or in the community on a 1:1 basis. Workers have a discussion with the Deaf / Deafblind person to identify their personal goals.

They can help to develop people's skills and confidence relating to several areas, including:

- Independent Travel including to and from work
- Shopping and accessing the community
- Forming links with the Deaf community and/or local community
- Promoting Independence with Household Routines
- Use of technology to access remote interpreting services and connect with services, friends and family
- Managing Finances and Household Bills
- Meal Planning and Preparation
- Transitioning to Adulthood
- Undertaking voluntary or paid work
- Developing communication skills such as deafblind manual and hands on signing

Promoting Independence workers do **not** offer support relating to personal care.

How do you introduce someone to an ADVIS Promoting Independence Worker?

Individuals are commonly introduced to an ADVIS Promoting Independence Worker by a social care worker from ADVIS. A Rehabilitation Officer, Technical Officer or Social Worker from ADVIS will have been in contact with the individual and identified that they could benefit from the PIW

service. Alternatively, community workers or family members can discuss the service with the individual who can self-refer. If the person is suitable for this type of support, they will be allocated a Promoting Independence worker.

How long do people typically receive support from the ADVIS Promoting Independence Workers?

Support can be provided for up to 12 weeks but can be less or more depending on an individual's needs and goals.

What outcomes would we hope that people achieve, having been supported by a Promoting Independence worker?

ADVIS Promoting Independence Workers hope to support individuals to achieve their desired personal goals and to increase their level of independence and confidence.

By supporting people to achieve their goals, it is hoped that the individual will experience an improvement in their day to day living and benefit from learning new skills and a variety of new opportunities and experiences.

Adult Deaf & Visual Impairment Service

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